

## Mobile Britney

Ditch the long queues for tickets or even the mosh-pits and stampedes at a concert. Hear your favourite artiste on your cell phone. JCOR Wireless, a unit of JCOR Entertainment, has signed

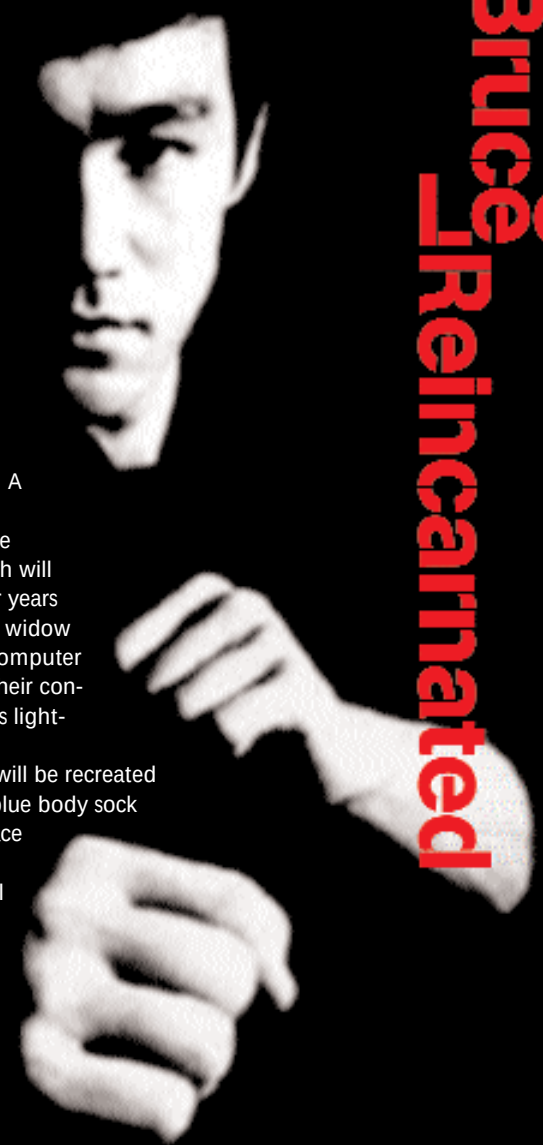


a deal with Britney Spears, Justin Timberlake of N'SYNC, rapper Jay-Z and other musicians to develop a wireless system that uses a combination of music, voice messages and text-based data to deliver a real-time entertainment experience. JCOR says it will market its wireless entertainment system to wireless operators, handset makers and retailers and plans to roll out its wireless entertainment offerings in the first half of 2002. Meanwhile Britney waits.

**B**ruce Lee's legacy is not over yet. Chul Shin, a South Korean filmmaker, is planning to cast him in the starring role in his next film. Never mind that Lee passed away in 1973. A \$50 million budget will allow Lee's image to be digitally recreated in the leading role in *Dragon Warrior*, which will be released in 2004. Shin spent four years getting permission from Bruce Lee's widow and daughter to recreate him in a computer animated movie. Now that he has their consent, the star will be back with all his lightning fury.

The digitally created Bruce Lee will be recreated with live actors using an actor in a blue body sock and capturing both film and 3D space data to then overlay Lee's rendered visage. Shin promises the effects will be better than *Final Fantasy*. The advent of the digital actor is the beginning of the loosening of the stranglehold Hollywood has on move making. We could potentially see a transition of stardom from actual people to the collaboration of body actors, voice actors and modellers/animators.

**Bruce Lee  
Reincarnated**



## AUDIO FINGERPRINTING

**H**ear a good number at a place but miss the name of the song? Philips Electronics is devising a new technique called Audio Fingerprinting. The technology allows you to get not just a track's title but the artiste and album as well. And all this within a few seconds.

Audio Fingerprinting works by holding a mobile phone to a radio's speaker for three sec-



onds, which is long enough to record a digital fingerprint. The cell phone then sends the fingerprint to a database server to lookup for matches. In four seconds, a message on the cell phone window pops up presenting the user with full information about the song, artiste, and so on. The technology is based upon a calculation

process involving a song's tempo, pitch and dynamics.

If this technology flies correctly, its usage could be more mainstream. For example, an ISP could offer services to customers who download MP3s to assist them in organising their music collection in their PC. Agencies of the recording industry can use this to identify and organise which songs are being played on radio.

## Tour White House

To make up for the disappointment caused by the cancellation of its popular holiday season tours for security reasons after the September 11 tragedy, the White House is offering the public a 360-degree tour of six of its rooms through its Web site [www.whitehouse.gov](http://www.whitehouse.gov). All these rooms have been lavishly decorated for the holidays. Click on the links to photographs of the rooms and scroll around to see the entire room, and zoom in on decorated trees and paintings.

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